

NORTHSTAR OUTFITTERS

Sizing, Fit, Materials & Product Care Guide

Footwear and apparel measurements, fit guidance, materials, cleaning, and product-care boundaries

CUSTOMER SAFE

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Document owner	Product Education
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Purpose	Customer-facing reference for fit and care questions used together with live Shopify variant data.

Demo environment only. Northstar Outfitters, its customers, products, prices, orders, and commercial terms are fictional and created for SupportOps demonstrations.

Document Control

Audience	Customers and Support
Scope	Sizing, measurement, footwear fit, apparel fit, materials, cleaning, waterproofing, care, and fit-related exchanges
Authority	Authoritative for general fit/care guidance. Shopify is authoritative for which sizes/colors/variants currently exist and can be purchased.
Review cycle	Quarterly or after a material policy/commerce change
Change control	Material changes require owner review and publication before becoming authoritative knowledge.

Knowledge governance

Only documents marked PUBLISHED in SupportOps are authoritative for customer-facing answers. Current Shopify catalog, variant, price, availability, cart, and authenticated order state should be obtained from the approved Shopify MCP capability rather than inferred from static documentation.

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1. How to Use This Guide

Sizing guidance helps customers choose among variants that actually exist in the current catalog. Always retrieve current Shopify variants before recommending a specific size/color for purchase.

Fit is guidance, not guarantee

Body and foot shape vary. A size chart supports selection but cannot guarantee personal fit.

2. Foot Measurement

1. Measure near the end of the day when feet are naturally slightly expanded.
2. Stand with weight evenly distributed.
3. Measure heel-to-longest-toe length for both feet.
4. Use the larger measurement when feet differ.
5. Compare the measurement with the product size chart and consider the product fit note.

3. Footwear Size Chart

EU	Approx. foot length (cm)	US Men	US Women
36	22.5	4	5.5
37	23.2	5	6.5
38	23.9	6	7.5
39	24.6	6.5	8
40	25.3	7.5	9
41	26.0	8.5	10
42	26.7	9	10.5
43	27.4	10	11.5
44	28.1	11	12.5
45	28.8	12	13.5
46	29.5	13	14.5

Conversions are approximate demo guidance. If a live product page provides a product-specific chart, the product-specific information takes priority.

4. Footwear Fit Guidance

Product	Fit character	Guidance
RidgeTrail Pro	Performance-oriented trail fit	Customers between sizes or wanting thicker trail socks may prefer the larger adjacent size after measurement.
CityStride Knit	Flexible everyday fit	Knit upper adapts more than a structured trail upper; use measured length as primary guide.

5. Apparel Measurement

- Chest: measure around fullest part, tape level.
- Waist: measure around natural waist without pulling tape tight.
- Hip: measure around fullest part of hips.
- Inseam: measure from crotch to desired hem.
- If between sizes, consider intended layering and preferred fit.

6. Apparel Size Chart

Size	Chest (cm)	Waist (cm)	Hip (cm)
XS	84-89	69-74	84-89
S	90-95	75-80	90-95
M	96-101	81-86	96-101
L	102-108	87-93	102-108
XL	109-116	94-101	109-116
XXL	117-124	102-109	117-124

7. Outerwear Layering

SummitShell Jacket is designed as a shell layer. Customers expecting to wear a substantial fleece or insulation layer underneath should measure while wearing representative layers and choose based on the resulting chest/shoulder requirement.

8. Materials Terminology

Term	Meaning in customer guidance
Water-resistant	Designed to resist light moisture; not equivalent to waterproof under sustained exposure.
Waterproof shell	Designed with waterproof barrier/construction as stated for the product; performance depends on care and condition.
Knit upper	Flexible textile footwear upper with different structure than rigid overlays.
Technical synthetic	Engineered material chosen for weight, durability, stretch, or weather properties depending on product.

9. Water Resistance and Waterproofing

Do not use waterproof and water-resistant interchangeably. A waterproof product can still require proper closure, seam construction, and maintenance. Damage, contamination, or incorrect washing can reduce performance.

10. Footwear Care

- Remove loose dirt with a soft brush.
- Use cool/lukewarm water and mild cleaner where needed.
- Do not machine dry or place directly against high heat.
- Remove insoles/laces for separate cleaning if product construction allows.
- Air dry away from direct intense heat.

11. Technical Shell Care

- Follow the care label first.
- Close zippers and fasteners before washing.
- Use mild technical-friendly detergent.
- Avoid fabric softener because it can impair performance finishes.
- Use low heat only if the care label permits it.

12. Pants Care

TrailFlex Pants should be washed cool with similar colors and dried according to the care label. High heat can shorten the life of stretch materials.

13. Bags and Accessories Care

- Spot clean bags unless the product label states otherwise.
- Empty pockets before cleaning.
- Do not use abrasive chemicals on coated materials.
- Dry bottles fully between uses; follow current product-page care instructions for dishwasher compatibility.

14. Fit Uncertainty and Returns

When a customer is uncertain between sizes, provide measurement guidance and current available variants. Do not promise a perfect fit. Remind the customer of the 30-day return policy and indoor footwear try-on requirements where relevant.

15. FAQ

Q. I normally wear EU 42. Should I order EU 42?

A. Use your measured foot length and the product fit note rather than relying only on your usual size.

Q. Can I wear RidgeTrail Pro outside to test fit and still return it?

A. Footwear should be tried indoors on a clean surface for change-of-mind return eligibility.

Q. Is water-resistant the same as waterproof?

A. No.

Q. Can I put trail shoes in a dryer?

A. High heat is not recommended; air dry unless the product label explicitly says otherwise.

Q. What sizes are currently in stock?

A. Use Shopify MCP/current catalog because availability is dynamic.

Appendix A - Measurement Troubleshooting

Problem	Guidance
Two feet measure differently	Use larger foot measurement as starting point
Measurement falls exactly between sizes	Use product fit note and sock/layer preference; avoid certainty
Customer only knows another brand size	Ask for cm measurement; brand conversions vary
Apparel chest and waist map to different sizes	Prioritize garment area most critical to fit and intended layering
Customer wants oversized fit	Use measurements plus intended ease; do not simply "size up" without context

Appendix B - Fit Conversation Examples

Customer statement	Helpful response approach
I am EU 42 in another brand	Ask for foot length in cm and compare to chart; retrieve available Shopify sizes
I wear thick hiking socks	Factor sock volume into fit discussion; a between-size customer may prefer larger adjacent size
I want shell over a fleece	Measure with representative layering; prioritize chest/shoulder mobility
I have a wide forefoot	Explain published fit character; do not diagnose or promise width accommodation if no width spec exists

Appendix C - Material Care Matrix

Material/product type	Cleaning	Avoid
Trail footwear upper	Soft brush, mild cleaner, air dry	Machine dryer/high direct heat
Knit footwear	Gentle spot cleaning, air dry	Aggressive scrubbing that distorts knit
Technical shell	Care-label wash, technical-friendly detergent	Fabric softener/bleach unless label permits
Stretch pants	Cool wash, mild detergent	High heat that degrades stretch
Backpack/coated fabric	Spot clean, air dry	Harsh solvents/abrasive scrubbing
Bottle	Follow product care spec	Assuming dishwasher-safe without current spec

Appendix D - Wear, Damage, and Defect Boundary

Normal wear is expected to develop over time and is different from an early material/construction defect. Support should avoid diagnosing from a single vague description. Ask for use duration, location of failure, conditions, and photos when practical. Potential safety failures should be escalated rather than investigated through repeated customer testing.

Appendix E - Care Advice Safety

- Product care labels take priority over general guidance.
- Do not recommend solvents or chemicals that are not approved in the product instructions.
- Do not suggest heat-based "fixes" that could damage materials.
- When a product is damaged or structurally compromised, care instructions are not a substitute for a defect evaluation.

Appendix F - Product-Specific Fit Scenarios

Scenario	Guidance
RidgeTrail Pro customer measures 26.5 cm	EU 42 is near the chart value; discuss sock thickness and performance fit, then check live EU 42 availability
CityStride customer between EU 40 and 41	Use measured length plus flexible knit fit; do not guarantee one size will fit
SummitShell customer wants thick fleece underneath	Measure chest with representative layer and choose enough ease for movement
TrailFlex customer prioritizes mobility	Use waist/hip measurements and product stretch positioning; avoid using height alone

Appendix G - Fit-Related Exchange Flow

11. Confirm the original item remains eligible under the returns policy.
12. Ask which fit issue occurred (length, width sensation, layering, etc.) without diagnosing medical foot/body conditions.
13. Retrieve the desired replacement size/variant live in Shopify.
14. If available, follow exchange workflow; if unavailable, explain refund/alternative options.
15. Remind footwear customers that exchange/return eligibility depends on indoor try-on condition.